

RY X — THE ALBUM

01 Proposal

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THE BRIEF, IN ONE LINE

Someone in Europe on Ry’s side of the table, pushing.

Not another partner with a lane. One person whose only artist on this record is Ry X, who holds the plan across every market, runs the media, builds the real-world moments, and reports every week on what the money did.

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WHAT IS ALREADY IN PLACE

A lot of good people, each with a lane.

None of this needs replacing. What is missing is the person who sits in the middle of it from Ry's point of view — particularly in Europe, where the distributor's attention is spread across a roster.

Distribution

The Orchard

The record, the ad budget, and the German office now engaged.

US publicity

Shore Fire

Josh, pitching US press and reaching into the bigger UK titles.

Radio & club

Circa

US non-comm and specialty, club promo — and building out in Europe.

Latin America

D Music

Project management for Anglo artists in the region, in conversation.

Brands

Firebird

The deck for sponsors, due this week; Orchard Germany's brands team behind it.

Physical

Diggers · Merch Collective

Vinyl in manufacture, shipping to the EU and the US; D2C in place.

Content

Videos for every song

Already shot. The campaign is distribution, not production.

The gap

Europe, from Ry's side

A plan per market, the media, the moments on the ground, and the chasing. This proposal.

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THE JOB

Your product manager, in Europe

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WHAT WE TAKE ON

Four things, one team, November to March.

01

The plan, per market

US, Germany, the UK and Belgium each get their own read and their own plan, held in one place. We sit between Red Light, Orchard's offices and every partner, and we do the chasing so you are not.

02

The media

Every release tested before it is spent on, scaled while it is working, and reported on cost per acquisition — not cost per click. Run on Ry's pages and on our third-party pages, the way the Elderbrook campaign runs now.

03

The real world

The in-stores, the stripped-down radio, the closer events. We find the rooms and the collaborators in Europe, help land a sponsor, and get the right people into the room.

04

Pitching, when it counts

DSP and editorial, through our network, for the record as what it is — and only at the moments that deserve it. Going to the well is something you can only do so many times.

The same shape as Øneheart. Marc Sheinman brought us in to be the middle of that campaign, and it is what we already do on Elderbrook for Red Light. Nothing in this proposal is new to us; it is new to this record.

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THE CAMPAIGN

Four releases, one album

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THE SHAPE OF IT

October to April.

29 OCTOBER

Lay

Out this week, unpitched. The first read on the record, through third-party channels, from tomorrow.

19 NOVEMBER

The November single

The real launch: album pre-save and vinyl pre-order open. The campaign starts here in earnest.

JANUARY

The third single

Scaling what November found. The in-store and radio asks are already out.

FEBRUARY

The album

12th, 19th or 25th — the vinyl decides. LA, New York, then Europe inside release week.

APRIL

Europe on tour

Not ours — but every fan captured between now and then is a cheaper ticket sold.

One date sets everything else. The album lands when the vinyl lands at Orchard, and the in-stores, the radio sessions and the European week all hang off it. Until it is confirmed, every plan in here is built to move a week either way without breaking.

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RELEASE 01 OF 04

29 October

Lay

Already moving

The first number arrives before anyone has signed anything.

Lay goes out this week unpitched, into Spotify's wellness week, because Ry wanted it out. That makes it the ideal test: no editorial to wait on, no pre-save to protect, just the record against real audiences through our third-party channels, exactly as we run it for Elderbrook. By the time the November single is live we know which part of this record stops a scroll, and in which country.

01

Third-party channels

Our own pages, warm audiences already there, Lay in front of them from tomorrow.

02

A small spend, a real read

Enough to learn what a listener costs by market — the US, Germany, the UK, Belgium — not enough to matter if the answer is no.

03

It counts against month one

The quick start is £250 plus 20% on spend, and comes off the first month if the full campaign goes ahead.

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RELEASE 02 OF 04

19 November

The November single

Album pre-save and vinyl pre-order open

This is the launch. It should be the first time the budget is spent knowing something.

Ry has told his audience the album is coming; this is the day it becomes real to them, with the pre-save and the vinyl both live. Holy Water showed what happens when the ads work and nobody is watching: it was doing well, and by the time anyone could see that, the ads had stopped. This time the person watching is the person with their hand on the budget.

01

Test the record itself

Every section of the song against a control visual, then up to twenty-five cuts of the winner — film, the videos, Ry's own content.

02

Scale while it is working

Cost per acquisition read daily, by market. When a cut is converting, the budget moves to it that day, not after the month closes.

03

The pre-save is the outcome

The campaign drives at the album, not the single: the single is the way in, the pre-save is what we count.

04

The asks go out now

Rough Trade, Amoeba, a German store, the radio sessions. They are booked months out, so the February week starts being built in November.

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RELEASE 03 OF 04

January

The third single

By now the campaign has a memory, and January spends it.

Two singles in, we know the sound that converts, the markets that respond and what a listener costs in each of them. January is not a new test. It is the first release that opens warm — to the list the first two built, to the pre-saves, to the people who bought the vinyl early — and it holds that audience through to the album.

01

Open to a warm audience first

The capture from October and November reached before a pound goes on cold reach.

02

Weight the markets

If Germany is converting at half the cost of the UK, Germany gets more of the budget. Decided from the numbers, with you, in the weekly.

03

Lock the February week

Dates, rooms and the European sessions confirmed and advanced, so release week is run rather than discovered.

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RELEASE 04 OF 04

February

The album

LA on the Monday, New York, then Europe by the weekend

The record lands with Ry in the room, in the places that matter to it.

Ry wants to be out and doing things this time, and his audience wants him in a room: in-stores, stripped-down sessions, the kind of close events he already plays. Red Light and Orchard's US team hold the American leg. We hold the European one — the rooms, the advancing, the marketing around each stop, and the capture at every door — and we hold the week together across the Atlantic so it reads as one campaign.

01

The in-stores

Rough Trade in London, a German store through Orchard Germany, and the two US dates built into one route.

02

Stripped-down radio

KCRW and KEXP are the US wish-list; we find the European equivalents and make the asks early, while there is still a calendar.

03

Spend to the week

The album budget weighted around release week in every market, then held into the fortnight after, when album campaigns usually go quiet.

04

Capture everywhere

Every room, every session, every stop feeds the list — in Ry's own way, through the newsletter, not a countdown.

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HOW

Testing, not spending

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PAID MEDIA

The question is what a listener costs. Everything else is a click.

Cost per click is what Meta tells you. Cost per acquisition is what happens after the click — who actually arrived at the record — and it is the number that decides whether to spend more. We report it weekly, per cut and per market, and we scale on it.

01

Find the sound

Every section of the song against the same control visual. The part that holds attention is the part the campaign is built on.

02

Cut in every direction

Up to twenty-five visuals around the winning sound: film, the videos, Ry's own footage. Against cold audiences, in each market separately.

03

Run on both kinds of page

Ry's content on his pages; our content on third-party pages that already have the audience. Both read against Spotify for Artists.

04

Decide, together, weekly

Go harder on this one, or hold it for the next? An honest conversation about the data, with the people who can act on it the same day.

It does not tell you a song is better or worse. It tells you how effectively paid media can work on it — which is the thing worth knowing before the budget goes out.

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THE REAL WORLD

The moments he already makes, with the right people in the room.

The closer events — the sound baths, the meditations — are the most Ry X thing in the campaign, and people love him in that space. The job is not to invent an activation. It is to put one of those in New York and one in Europe, find the sponsor that makes it pay for itself, and have the DSPs, the press and the partners in the room when it happens.

01

The sponsor

Firebird's deck goes to brands this week; Orchard Germany has offered its brands team; we add our own relationships. Three routes to one partner, run from one place.

02

The collaborators

We know the people in Europe who build this kind of experience well. The room, the sound, the light — done by someone who has done it before, not by a promoter's marketing budget.

03

What it leaves behind

Content the campaign can run for weeks, and a list of the people who came. The real world is part of digital now; this is where the fans get captured, on Ry's terms.

Nothing here asks Ry to sell. No drop, no countdown, no co-brand. His newsletter is the only call to action in the deck, because it is the one he already makes.

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PITCHING

Rarely, deliberately, and for the record it is.

This album is not a dance record, and it will not be pitched as one. In the UK it reads as alternative pop; in the US it sits with the indie and alternative editors rather than the electronic ones. We pitch it to the people whose playlists it actually belongs on, through a network that is global and that we do not go to every week.

Which is why Lay is not being pitched, and why the November single is. You can only go to the well so many times, so we go when the record has a pre-save behind it, a date, and a story — and we go with the numbers from the first campaign in hand, which is the thing an editor cannot get anywhere else.

No playlist is promised in this document. What is promised is that every ask is made at the right moment, to the right person, with evidence — and that you will know what was asked and what came back.

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HOW WE WORK

One team, one weekly

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WHO DOES WHAT

Label people, running it the way a label should.

Peter Jarrett ACCOUNTABLE

Twenty years in: A&R at Universal Publishing and Mercury, a producer signed to Black Butter, then brand and creative at 72andSunny, then a label through The Orchard. Sets the strategy and is in the room for the decisions that matter.

Product management

Pierre Hall

Label manager at Bella Union for years, DFA Records, then senior product manager at Believe. Has run exactly this job from inside the label.

Paid media

Tobi Steinborn

Co-founder, runs the media. The campaigns behind Elderbrook, Ninja Tune and all of Better Noise, and the Red Light work already live.

Fifteen people now, from two at the start of the year. The campaign gets a named day-to-day lead from this team in the first week; Peter stays accountable for all of it.

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REPORTING

Every week, without being asked.

A written report every Monday and the dashboard open all week: spend, cost per acquisition by cut and by market, what the record did on Spotify, where every partner is, and what needs a decision from you and by when.

You should never have to chase a number, and never find out an ad stopped after it did.



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FROM YOUR SIDE

Five things and we are running.

01

The vinyl date

The day it is confirmed, the album date is, and the February week can be booked. Everything in here is built to wait for it.

02

The money route

The ad budget sits with Orchard. We invoice them for spend and run it; you said you would work that out with them, and we will help.

03

Access

Meta business assets, Spotify for Artists, the videos for every song, and the newsletter — so Lay can start tomorrow.

04

One thread per partner

Orchard's US and German teams, Shore Fire, Circa, Firebird. One introduction each; after that the chasing is ours.

05

An hour with Ry

Before anything is built. It is better to go with his energy than against it, and we need to hear from him what feels right and what does not.

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THE ENGAGEMENT · NOVEMBER TO MARCH

Five months, two ways to do it.

MONTHLY

£5,000 a month

Five payments, £25,000 across the term, invoiced monthly from 1 November.

UP FRONT

£20,000

The same five months for **£5,000 less** — four paid up front and the fifth on us. The deal Øneheart took.

The fee includes the media. No 20% on ad spend on top — the management of every pound of it is in the retainer, along with the product management, the activations, the pitching and the in-stores.

On top, at cost, never marked up: the ad spend itself, from Orchard's budget; the hard costs of each event, which the sponsor should carry; and any third-party software. Lay starts tomorrow at £250 plus 20% on its spend, credited against month one.

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Lay is out tomorrow. The launch is three weeks away.

The quick start runs either way. If the shape of the rest is right, the next step is yours with Steve, then an hour with Ry, and we are in from 1 November.

01

Lay live through our channels, from tomorrow.

02

This goes to Steve, and then to Ry.

03

An hour with Ry, and the vinyl date.

04

1 November: the November single in test, the February asks out.

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